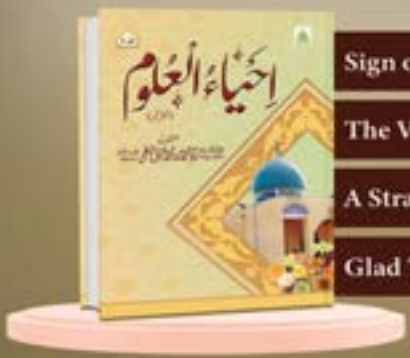
Weekly Booklet

TRANSLATION DEPARTMENT

Matters of Knowledge and Action (Part 3)

(A Beautiful Collection of Knowledge, Practice, Etiquette, and Spiritual Refinement, Derived from Ihya Ul Uloom by Imam Ghazali رحمۃ اللہ علیہ)



- Sign of the Acceptance of Hajj
- The Virtue of Concealed Deeds
- A Strange Thing About Dreams
- Glad Tidings of Forgiveness

علم وعمل کی باتیں(قسط:3)

Matters of Knowledge and Action (Part: 3)

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اَلْحَمْدُ لِلّٰهِ رَبِّ الْعٰلَمِيْنَ وَالصَّلٰوةُ وَالسَّلَامُ عَلٰى خَاتَمِ النَّبِيّٖنَ

اَمَّا بَعْدُ فَاَعُوْذُ بِاللّٰهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطٰنِ الرَّجِيْمِ بِسْمِ اللّٰهِ الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيْمِ

Matters of Knowledge and Action (Part: 3)[1]

Prayer of Attar:

O Generous Lord! Whoever reads this booklet, "Matters of Knowledge and Action (Part: 3)," grant them the success to perform pious deeds. Grant them, their parents, and family entry into Jannat al-Firdous without accountability.

اٰمِيْن بِجَاہِ خَاتَمِ النَّبِيّٖن صَلَّى اللّٰهُ عَلَيْهِ وَاٰلِهٖ وَسَلَّم

Virtue of reciting Ṣalāt upon the Merciful Prophet ﷺ

The majestic command of the Final Prophet of Allah Almighty صَلَّى اللّٰهُ عَلَيْهِ وَاٰلِهٖ وَسَلَّم, is: Whoever recites Salat upon me three times during the day and three times during the night out of longing and love, it is the right of Allah Almighty that He forgives the sins of that day and night for him.[2]

صَلُّوْا عَلَى الْحَبِيْب صَلَّى اللّٰهُ عَلٰى مُحَمَّد

Etiquettes of the Journey for Hajj

(1) The person going for Hajj should begin with repentance. (2) He should make a pious person his companion, who seeks goodness. (3) He should pray two rak'ahs when leaving home. (4) He should recite a prayer at the door of the house. (5) He should recite a prayer when mounting his ride. (6) He should not camp anywhere until the day becomes hot; most of the travel should be at night. (7) He should be very cautious during the day and not walk alone, separate from the caravan. (8) When climbing a high place, he should recite "اللہ اکبر" three times.[3]

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[1] This booklet has been prepared from the book of Al-Madinah al-Ilmiyyah, "Ihya al-Ulum (Urdu)," vol. 1

[2] Mu'jam Kabir, vol. 18, p. 362, Hadith: 928

[3] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, pp. 753 to 759, summarised and excerpted

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Internal Etiquettes of Hajj

(1) Expenses (nafaqah) should be from halal earnings. (2) There should be plenty of travel provisions. (3) He should give up useless talk (rafas), sin, and arguing. (4) If possible, he should perform Hajj on foot, as this is better. (5) Ride a pack animal without a saddle. (6) The pilgrim's clothing should be simple and plain; he should have unkempt hair and should not use too much adornment. (7) He should treat his ride gently. (8) He should attain nearness to Allah Almighty by offering sacrifice. (9) He should spend money happily on travel provisions or sacrifice during the journey for Hajj.[1]

Four Types of Hajj

It is narrated that, 'In the final era, people will set out for Hajj in four categories: kings for luxury and comfort, the wealthy for trade, the poor for begging, and the reciters for showing off."[2]

Religion and the World

Allah Almighty grants the world in exchange for religion, but He does not grant religion in exchange for the world.[3]

Any action that leads towards something forbidden is also forbidden.[4]

Why is Travel Called 'Safar'?

Travel is called 'Safar' because it reveals the character of people.[5] And if you wish to know what a person is really like, travel with him.

Taqwa

A person said to Sayyiduna Abdullah bin Mubarak رَحْمَةُ اللّٰهِ عَلَيْه: "Please deliver this letter of mine to so-and-so." He replied: "Wait! Let me take permission from the

[1] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, pp. 793 to 802, summarised
[2] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 793
[3] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 794
[4] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 795
[5] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 796

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owner of the ride, because I have taken this animal on rent." Observe! He practised Taqwa even in the matter of carrying a letter, although it has no weight. This is the way of caution in Taqwa, because if the door to a small matter is opened, it gradually leads to greater things.[1]

Sign of the Acceptance of Hajj

It is narrated that one sign of the acceptance of Hajj is that the person gives up the disobediences he was involved in. He should leave his bad friends and choose the company of the pious, and leave gatherings of idle talk and negligence to join gatherings of remembrance, reflection, and wakefulness.[2]

The Best Way to Attain Nearness to Allah Almighty

Sayyiduna Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal رَحْمَةُ اللّٰهِ عَلَيْه says: In a dream, I was blessed with the vision of Allah Almighty. I submitted: "O Pure Lord! Which deed is most excellent in Your sight, through which the near ones attain Your nearness?" It was said: "O Ahmad! It is My Pure Word (the Holy Qur'an)." I submitted: "O Pure Lord! Should it be recited with understanding or without understanding?" It was said: "Whether it is recited with understanding or without understanding."[3]

Three Causes of Memory Strength

The fourth Caliph of the Muslims, Sayyiduna Ali al-Murtaza رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ عَنْہُ, says: Three things increase memory strength and eliminate phlegm: (1) using the miswak, (2) fasting, and (3) reciting the Holy Qur'an.[4]

What Connection Do you Have With Our Words?

Some pious scholars say: "When the son of Adam is occupied with useless talk during recitation and then starts reading again, he is told: 'What connection do you

[1] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 800
[2] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 803
[3] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 826
[4] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 827

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have with Our Words?'"[1]

Due to Frequent Recitation...?

The third Caliph of the Muslims, Sayyiduna Uthman Ghani رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ عَنْہُ, used to recite so frequently that because of this, two copies of the Mushaf Sharif became worn out. Many Companions رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ عَنْہُم used to read the Holy Qur'an by looking at it, and did not like to spend a day without looking at the Holy Qur'an.[2]

Allah Almighty's Speech to His Servant

It is mentioned in the Holy Taurat that Allah Almighty says: "O servant! Do you not feel shy before Me? You are walking on the road, and a letter from some brother of yours comes to you; you step aside from the path, sit down, and read every single letter of it with great attention. Yet this is My book, which I have revealed to you. Look! How much detail is in it for you; how many times I have explained it to you so that you may reflect upon its length and breadth, yet you turn away from it. Is My status, in your view, lower than that of your brothers? O My servant! When your brother sits with you, you turn towards him completely and focus your heart entirely on his words. If someone speaks during this time or interrupts his talk, you silence them with a gesture. Now, while I am addressing you and speaking to you, your heart is turning away from Me. Have you regarded Me as being of even less importance than your own brothers?[3]

Recite the Holy Qur'an with Sorrow

It is recommended to weep while reciting the Holy Qur'an. The Beloved Prophet صَلَّی اللّٰہُ عَلَیْہِ وَاٰلِہٖ وَسَلَّم said: "Recite the Qur'an and weep! If you cannot weep, then assume the expression of weeping."[4]

Recite the Holy Qur'an in a Beautiful Voice

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[1] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 828
[2] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 843
[3] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 830
[4] Ibn Majah, vol. 2, p. 129, Hadith: 1337; Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 836

In one narration, it is mentioned that "the person who does not recite the Holy Qur'an in a beautiful voice is not among us."[1]

Explanation of the Hadith: The person who does not recite the Holy Qur'an with a beautiful voice (i.e., a pleasant voice) is outside our way. It is known that even a person with a poor voice should try as much as possible to recite beautifully, as a pleasant voice in the Holy Qur'an is its ornament. This creates an attraction in the recitation, draws the hearts of people, and therefore serves as a means of preaching.[2]

صَلُّوْا عَلَى الْحَبِيْب　　صَلَّى اللّٰهُ عَلٰى مُحَمَّد

Where is the Weeping?

Sayyiduna Salih Murrsi رَحْمَةُ اللّٰهِ عَلَيْه says: In a dream, I recited the Holy Qur'an before the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللّٰهُ عَلَيْهِ وَاٰلِهٖ وَسَلَّم, and he صَلَّى اللّٰهُ عَلَيْهِ وَاٰلِهٖ وَسَلَّم asked: "O Salih! This is the recitation of the Qur'an, but where is the weeping?"[3]

Method of Natural Weeping

Sayyiduna Abdullah bin Abbas رَضِیَ اللّٰهُ عَنْهُمَا says: "When you recite a verse of prostration for Allah Almighty, do not rush to prostrate until you begin to weep. If the eyes of any of you do not weep, then the heart should weep."

(The method) for this is to bring a feeling of sadness into the heart, which then causes weeping to occur. The Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللّٰهُ عَلَيْهِ وَاٰلِهٖ وَسَلَّم said: "The Qur'an was revealed with sadness; therefore, when you recite it, show sadness."[4]

Method of Creating a State of Sadness

One should remember the covenants and the commands and prohibitions (meaning the things commanded to be done and those commanded to be avoided). Then, if one reflects upon them in relation to his own affairs, he will certainly

[1] Bukhari, vol. 4, p. 586, Hadith: 7527; Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 836
[2] Mira al-Manajih, vol. 3, p. 266
[3] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 836
[4] Majma al-Zawaid, vol. 7, p. 351, Hadith: 11694, meaning; Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 836

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become sad and begin to weep. If a state of sadness and weeping does not come over him, as it does for those with pure hearts, then he should weep because he is unable to weep and be sad, because this is the greatest calamity.[1]

The Virtue of Concealed Deeds

It is mentioned in one narration that "a hidden deed is seventy times more virtuous than a public deed."[2]

Prophetic Saying Regarding Sayyiduna Abu Musa رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ عَنْہُ

The Holy Prophet صَلَّی اللّٰہُ عَلَیْہِ وَاٰلِہٖ وَسَلَّم heard the recitation of Sayyiduna Abu Musa Ash'ari رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ عَنْہُ and said: "He has been granted a beautiful voice like that of Dawud عَلَیْہِ السَّلَام."[3] When this reached Sayyiduna Abu Musa Ash'ari رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ عَنْہُ, he said: "O Messenger of Allah صَلَّی اللّٰہُ عَلَیْہِ وَاٰلِہٖ وَسَلَّم! If I had known that you were listening, I would have recited even more beautifully."[4]

What is in the noble Qur'an?

It is narrated that in the Holy Qur'an there are fields, gardens, rooms, brides, silky clothes, orchards, and inns (meaning resting places for travellers). The letter 'م' in the Holy Qur'an represents the fields, the letter 'ر' represents the gardens, and the letter 'ح' represents the rooms. The Surahs that begin with Tasbeeh are the brides of the Holy Qur'an. The word 'حٰمٓ' are the silky clothes of the Holy Qur'an, and the long Surahs are its orchards. Apart from these, there are inns. When a person who recites the Holy Qur'an enters the fields, picks fruits from the gardens, enters the rooms to visit the brides, wears silky clothes, and strolls through the orchards and stays

[1] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 837
[2] Shu'ab al-Iman, vol. 1, p. 408, Hadith: 556, meaning; Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 840
[3] Bukhari, vol. 3, p. 416, Hadith: 5048
[4] Quwat al-Qulub, vol. 1, p. 112; Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 844

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in the inns, all these things surround him and turn him away from everything else. Then, neither does his heart turn towards anything else, nor is his thought distracted.[1]

If Hearts Become Pure...

The third Caliph of the Muslims, Sayyiduna Uthman Ghani رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ عَنْہُ, and Sayyiduna Hudhayfa bin Yaman رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ عَنْہُ said: "If hearts become pure, they will never be satisfied with the recitation of the Holy Qur'an."[2]

When Does My Generous Lord Remember Me?

Sayyiduna Thabit al-Bunani رَحْمَۃُ اللّٰہِ عَلَیْہ says: "I know the moment (time) in which my Generous Lord remembers me." The people present asked eagerly: "How do you know this?" He replied: "When I remember Him, He remembers me."[3]

Two Types of Remembrance

Sayyiduna Hasan Basri رَحْمَۃُ اللّٰہِ عَلَیْہ says: “Remembrance (Zikr) is of two types: (1) That which is only between the servant and Allah Almighty (where no one else is aware). This remembrance is also most excellent and carries a great reward. (2) An even greater form of remembrance is that a person remains mindful of Allah Almighty when confronted with what He has forbidden” (i.e. the moment the thought of committing a forbidden act arises, they remember their Most Generous Lord and refrain from it).[4]

Etiquettes of Prayer

(1) One should keep in mind the best times for prayer. (2) The person praying should also benefit from holy states and circumstances. (3) Prayer should be made while facing the Qibla. (4) While praying, the voice should neither be so low that it is called silence, nor too loud. (5) Do not make a deliberate effort to use ornate,

[1] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 850
[2] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 871
[3] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 886
[4] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 890

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contrived language in your supplications. (6) The person praying should be humble and modest, and maintain both hope and fear. (7) There should be a firm belief and hope in the acceptance of the prayer. (8) One should be persistent in asking and repeat the prayer three times. (9) The prayer should begin with the remembrance of Allah Almighty, not with a request. (10) To repent, return any wealth that has been wrongfully taken, and strive with all one's might to turn to Allah Almighty.[1]

A Prayer of the Merciful Prophet ﷺ

The Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَاٰلِهٖ وَسَلَّم recited this prayer while in the state of prostration:

أَعُوذُ بِرِضَاكَ مِنْ سَخَطِكَ وَأَعُوذُ بِمُعَافَاتِكَ مِنْ عُقُوبَتِكَ وَأَعُوذُ بِكَ مِنْكَ لَا أُحْصِي ثَنَاءً عَلَيْكَ أَنْتَ كَمَا أَثْنَيْتَ عَلَى نَفْسِكَ

Meaning: I seek refuge in Your pleasure from Your displeasure, in Your pardon from Your punishment, (That is, seeking refuge in Your Attributes from Your Being, or seeking refuge in Your mercy from Your wrath). I cannot praise You as You deserve. You are as You have praised Yourself.[2]

Tasbeeh Should be Recited on the Fingers

Sayyiduna Abdullah bin Umar رَضِیَ اللهُ عَنْهُما says: "I saw the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَاٰلِهٖ وَسَلَّم reciting Tasbeeh while counting." In another narration, the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَاٰلِهٖ وَسَلَّم said: "Count on the fingers, because these fingers will speak."[3]

Definitely Pray

Sayyiduna Sufyan bin Uyaynah رَحْمَةُ اللهِ عَلَيْه says: "If you find any evil within yourself, do not stop praying, because Allah Almighty accepted the prayer of Satan, the worst of all creatures."[4]

A Beautiful Etiquette of Prayer

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[1] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, pp. 908 to 918
[2] Muslim, p. 252, Hadith: 476; Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 883
[3] Abu Dawood, vol. 2, p. 116, Hadith: 1501, 1502, meaning
[4] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 917

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One etiquette of prayer is to repeat the prayer three times. Sayyiduna Abdullah bin Masud رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ عَنْہُ says: whenever the Merciful Prophet صَلَّی اللّٰہُ عَلَیْہِ وَاٰلِہٖ وَسَلَّم made a prayer or a request, he did so three times.[1]

Do Whatever you Wish, I Have Forgiven you

When a servant commits a sin and then says: اَللّٰھُمَّ اغْفِرْلِی meaning: O Allah Almighty! Please forgive me, then Allah Almighty says: "My servant has committed a sin, yet he knows that he has a Lord who both punishes for sin and grants forgiveness. O My servant! Do whatever you wish, I have granted you forgiveness."[2]

صَلُّوْا عَلَی الْحَبِیْب　　صَلَّی اللّٰہُ عَلٰی مُحَمَّد

The Benefit of Asking for Forgiveness

A person who asks for forgiveness does not persist in sin, even if he sins seventy times a day.[3]

Regarding this pure Hadith, Mufti Ahmed Yar Khan رَحْمَۃُ اللّٰہِ عَلَیْہ says: (It is a condition that) at the time of repentance, there must be a complete intention to stay away from (meaning avoid) the sin. If, at the time of repentance, the thought is that he will continue to sin, then this is not repentance but (مَعاذَاللّٰہ) a joke with Islam.[4]

Sleeping is Better

Some pious predecessors say: A time will come upon people when, among all their deeds, the best deed will be silence and sleep. There are many worshippers whose best state is sleep. This is when he worships for show and there is no sincerity in it.[5]

What is Moderation in Sleep?

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[1] Muslim, p. 991, Hadith: 1794; Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 917
[2] Muslim, pp. 1474 to 1475, Hadith: 2758; Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 933
[3] Abu Dawood, vol. 2, p. 121, Hadith: 1514; Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 933
[4] Mirat al-Manajih, vol. 3, p. 364
[5] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 1007

Moderation in sleep is to sleep eight hours during the night and day. Then, if he has already slept for that many hours at night, there is no point in sleeping during the day.[1]

A Strange Thing About Dreams

The Merciful Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَاٰلِهٖ وَسَلَّم said: "When a servant sleeps while having wudu, his soul is taken towards the Arsh, and then his dreams are true. If he does not sleep with wudu, his soul remains unable to reach there, and he has disturbing dreams that are not true."[2]

Purity (Taharat) refers to both outer and inner purity. Inner purity is effective in revealing the veils of the unseen.[3]

Will He Never Forget the Holy Qur'an?

It is narrated that whoever recites these verses while sleeping, Allah Almighty will keep the Holy Qur'an preserved for him (meaning He will grant him the success to remember the Holy Qur'an), and he will never forget the Holy Qur'an.

وَاِلٰهُكُمْ اِلٰهٌ وَّاحِدٌۚ لَاۤ اِلٰهَ اِلَّا هُوَ الرَّحْمٰنُ الرَّحِیْمُ ﴿۱۶۳﴾ اِنَّ فِیْ خَلْقِ السَّمٰوٰتِ وَ الْاَرْضِ وَ اخْتِلَافِ الَّیْلِ وَ النَّهَارِ وَ الْفُلْكِ الَّتِیْ تَجْرِیْ فِی الْبَحْرِ بِمَا یَنْفَعُ النَّاسَ وَ مَاۤ اَنْزَلَ اللّٰهُ مِنَ السَّمَآءِ مِنْ مَّآءٍ فَاَحْیَا بِهِ الْاَرْضَ بَعْدَ مَوْتِهَا وَ بَثَّ فِیْهَا مِنْ كُلِّ دَآبَّةٍ ۪ وَّ تَصْرِیْفِ الرِّیٰحِ وَ السَّحَابِ الْمُسَخَّرِ بَیْنَ السَّمَآءِ وَ الْاَرْضِ لَاٰیٰتٍ لِّقَوْمٍ یَّعْقِلُوْنَ ﴿۱۶۴﴾[4]

Virtue of Participating in a Congregation

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[1] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 1009
[2] Mu'jam Awsat, vol. 4, p. 63, Hadith: 5220, excerpted
[3] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 1019
[4] Al-Quran, Surah Al-Baqarah, verses 163-164; translation from Kanz al-ʿIrfān

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Sayyiduna Ka'b al-Ahbar رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ عَنْہُ said: If the reward of the gatherings of scholars became apparent to people, they would fight one another for it, so much so that every ruler would leave his government and every shopkeeper would leave his shop.[1]

O Lord of Fire! Save me from it

In the era of Prophethood, it was the habit of a person that when people slept, he would pray, recite the Holy Qur'an, and submit in the court of Allah Almighty: يَا رَبَّ النَّارِ أَجِرْنِي مِنْهَا meaning: O Lord of the Fire! Save me from it. This person was mentioned in the blessed court of the Final Prophet صَلَّی اللّٰہُ عَلَیْہِ وَاٰلِہٖ وَسَلَّم, and the Holy Prophet صَلَّی اللّٰہُ عَلَیْہِ وَاٰلِہٖ وَسَلَّم said: "When this happens again, inform me." (Consequently, when he was informed, he visited the man and heard his words). When morning came, he صَلَّی اللّٰہُ عَلَیْہِ وَاٰلِہٖ وَسَلَّم said: "O so-and-so! Why did you not ask Allah Almighty for Paradise?" He submitted: "O Messenger of Allah صَلَّی اللّٰہُ عَلَیْہِ وَاٰلِہٖ وَسَلَّم! Neither I hold such status, and nor are my deeds worthy of it." Shortly after, Sayyiduna Jibril عَلَیْہِ السَّلَام appeared in the Blessed Court and submitted: "O Messenger of Allah صَلَّی اللّٰہُ عَلَیْہِ وَاٰلِہٖ وَسَلَّم! Inform him that Allah Almighty has saved him from the fire and admitted him into Paradise."[2]

The Ill-Effects of Sins

Sayyiduna Imam Hasan Basri رَحْمَۃُ اللّٰہِ عَلَیْہ says: "Because of sins, a servant is deprived of waking up at night to perform worship." Sayyiduna Fudayl bin Iyad رَحْمَۃُ اللّٰہِ عَلَیْہ says: "If you do not have the ability to wake up at night for worship and to keep fasts during the day, then know that you have been deprived, and that your sins have greatly increased."[3]

Congregation is Missed as a Punishment for Sin

[1] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 1038
[2] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 1054
[3] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 1057

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Sayyiduna Abu Sulayman Darani رَحْمَةُ اللّٰهِ عَلَيْه says: Missing a congregation is due to some sin of the person.[1]

Etiquettes of Sleeping

(1) Sleep after performing wudu and using miswak. (2) Keep miswak and water for wudu at the bedside. (3) Whoever has to make a will should not sleep without writing it and keeping it at the bedside. (4) Sleep after repenting for all sins. (5) Do not sleep on a soft and luxurious bed for the sake of luxury; rather, leave it completely or choose a medium-type bed. (6) Do not sleep until sleep overcomes him. (7) Sleep facing the Qibla. (8) Recite a prayer while sleeping. (9) Remember while sleeping that sleep is also a kind of death. (10) Recite a prayer upon waking up.[2]

Glad Tidings of Forgiveness

(1) Fasting. (2) Giving charity, even if it is a little. (3) Visiting the sick. (4) Attending funerals. Regarding these four matters, it is narrated that the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللّٰهُ عَلَيْهِ وَاٰلِهٖ وَسَلَّم said: "Whoever combines these four matters in one day, he will be forgiven." In one narration, it is mentioned that "he will enter Paradise."[3] If he gets the opportunity to do some of these and is unable to do others (due to some reason), he will receive the full reward for all of them based on his intention.[4]

Outward and Inward Means of Facilitating Night Vigil

Outer causes: (1) avoiding overeating, (2) not tiring the soul during the day, (3) taking a midday nap (qaylulah), (4) avoiding sins during the day.

Inner causes: (1) the heart being sound, having no grudge or malice, (2) fear being present in the heart. When Suhayb رَحْمَةُ اللّٰهِ عَلَيْه remembers Hell, he cannot sleep. (3) keep the verses, Ahadith, and the sayings of the Companions رَضِیَ اللّٰهُ عَنْهُم and Tabi'un

[1] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 1062
[2] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, pp. 1019 to 1026
[3] Muslim, p. 398, Hadith: 2374; Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 836
[4] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 1032

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رَحِمَهُمُ اللّٰهُ in view. (4) have firm faith in the Being of the Creator and complete love for Him in the heart.[1]

The Most Excellent Method of Night Vigil

He should stand in prayer in the first part of the night; when sleep overcomes him, he should sleep. When he wakes up, he should then stand in prayer again. Then, when sleep overcomes him, he should sleep. In this way, there will be two sleeps and two prayers for him during the night. This is among the hardships of the night. It is the most difficult and the most excellent; moreover, this is among the blessed manners of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللّٰهُ عَلَيْهِ وَاٰلِهٖ وَسَلَّم. A group of Companions رَضِیَ اللّٰهُ عَنْهُم and Tabi'un رَحِمَهُمُ اللّٰهُ followed this.[2]

A Saying of a Pious Predecessor Regarding Sleep

A pious predecessor says: Sleep is only for the first time; when I wake up and wish to sleep again, may Allah Almighty not let me sleep.[3]

[1] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, pp. 1060 to 1064
[2] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 1071
[3] Ihya al-Ulum, vol. 1, p. 1071

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